Marius Guenzel

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The Wharton School
University of Pennsylvania
SHDH, 3620 Locust Walk
Philadelphia, PA 19104

Phone: +1 (510) 612-4514
Email: mguenzel@wharton.upenn.edu
Homepage: www.mariusguenzel.com
fnce.wharton.upenn.edu/profile/mguenzel

Academic Positions

Assistant Professor of Finance, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, 2021–
Lecturer, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, 2020–2021

Affiliations

Labor and Finance Group, Member, 2025–
Wharton Neuroscience Initiative, Faculty Affiliate, 2021–
Analytics at Wharton, Faculty Affiliate, 2021–

Academic Visits

Yale SOM, Cowles Foundation Visitor, October 2024

Education

Ph.D. in Finance, Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley, 2021
Dissertation: "Essays in Behavioral Corporate Finance"
M.S. in Finance, Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley, 2017
M.Sc. in Business (with distinction), University of Mannheim, 2014
B.Sc. in Business, University of Mannheim, 2012

Research Interests

Primary Fields: Corporate Finance, Behavioral Finance
Secondary Fields: Organizational Economics, Labor Economics, Behavioral Economics

Papers

Publications and Forthcoming Papers

1. Behavioral Corporate Finance: The Life Cycle of a CEO Career (with U. Malmendier)
   Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Economics and Finance, Oxford University Press, 2020
2. In Too Deep: The Effect of Sunk Costs on Corporate Investment
   The Journal of Finance, June 2025, Vol 80 (3), pp. 1593-1646.
3. CEO Stress, Aging, and Death (with M. Borgschulte, C. Liu, and U. Malmendier)
   The Journal of Finance, December 2025, Vol 80 (6), pp. 3401-3442.

4. Excess Commitment in R&D (with T. Liu)
   The Review of Financial Studies, July 2026, Vol 39(7), pp. 2179-2221.

Working Papers

5. Prosociality and Layoffs (with C. Hamilton and U. Malmendier)
6. Longevity and Occupational Choice (with U. Malmendier and D. Sosyura)
7. What Drives Very Long-Run Cash Flow Growth Expectations? (with P. Decaire)
8. Mental Models and Financial Forecasts (with F. Bastianello and P. Decaire)
   The Quarterly Journal of Economics, reject & resubmit
9. Valuation Models (with F. Bastianello and P. Decaire)
10. AI Personality Extraction from Faces: Labor Market Implications (with S. Kogan, M. Niessner, and K. Shue)
    The Quarterly Journal of Economics, reject & resubmit
11. Facing Default? (with P. Garg, S. Kogan, M. Niessner, and K. Shue)

Work in Progress

12. Behavioral Corporate Finance: New Insights and Legal Perspectives
    Invited chapter for the *Oxford Handbook of Corporate Finance Law* (Oxford University Press), edited by F. Steffek and G. Rauterberg)

Presentations (External)

* indicates presentation by coauthor (conferences only)

2027: AFA (2 papers)
2026: AFA/ASSA (2 papers, discussant)
Utah Winter Finance Conference*
RCFS Winter Conference
Adam Smith Workshop*
NBER Labor Studies Spring Meeting*
WEFIDEV-RFS-CEPR Conference on Finance and Development (discussant)
HBS Junior Finance Conference
FSU Truist Beach Conference (2 papers)*
UCLA Fink Center Conference on Financial Markets (2 papers)*
SFS Cavalcade (2 papers)*
8th Future of Financial Information Conference*
Africa Business School Household Finance Conference*
WFA*
Carnegie Mellon University
University of Pittsburgh
Dartmouth (Tuck)
University of Michigan (Ross)
Cornell University (Finance)
University of Virginia (Darden)

Vanderbilt
University of Minnesota (Carlson)

2025: AFA (2 papers, session chair)
USC Macro Finance Conference (discussant)
ITAM Finance Conference*
UBC Winter Finance Conference
Young Scholars Finance Consortium
Labor and Finance Conference*
Adam Smith Workshop*
Kentucky Finance Conference*
MIT Sloan Junior Finance Conference*
NBER Organizational Economics Spring Meeting
NBER Corporate Finance Spring Meeting*
NBER Asset Pricing Spring Meeting*
NBER Long-Term Asset Management Spring Meeting
FSU Truist Beach Conference
1st Annual Isenberg School of Management Finance Conference
SFS Cavalcade
7th Future of Financial Information Conference
Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference
ABFER*
4th Quadrant Behavioral Finance Conference*
TUM's 2nd Workshop on NLP and Generative AI*
WFA*
SITE Asset Pricing Workshop*
Boulder Summer Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making
NBER Corporate Finance Summer Institute
4th Valuation Conference*
Chicago Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference*
FRA Early Ideas Session*
Chicago Fed
Cornell University (Economics)
Vanderbilt
Stevens Institute of Tech
LSE (Finance)
Maryland

2024: AFA (paper*, discussant)
MFA Conference*
Mid-Atlantic Research Conference in Finance
Texas Finance Festival*
NBER Corporate Finance Spring Meeting
Adam Smith Workshop
SFS Cavalcade*
Ageing and Sustainable Finance Conference
Behavioral Finance Conference at Bocconi University
CEPR Economics of Longevity and Ageing Conference

CESifo Venice Summer Institute
NBER Summer Institute Labor Studies
Yale Junior Finance Conference*
SAFE Household Finance Workshop 2024*
Purdue Fintech Conference 2024*
Research in Behavioral Finance Conference*
1st Workshop on LLMs and Generative AI for Finance
Drexel University
University of Mannheim
Yale SOM

2023: AFA*
RCFS Winter Finance Conference
Mid-Atlantic Research Conference in Finance (discussant)
Drexel Corporate Governance Conference
Kentucky Finance Conference
LBS Summer Finance Symposium
Erasmus Corporate Governance Conference
WFA (discussant)
ENTFIN Conference (paper, discussant)
SITE Psychology and Economics
EFA
JCF Conference on Ownership and Corporate Social and Sustainable Policies (paper, discussant)
NFA (paper, discussant, session chair)
Oxford Sustainable Private Markets Conference (discussant)
Finance, Organizations and Markets (FOM) Conference (discussant)
NBER Behavioral Finance Fall Meeting
NBER Health Economics Fall Meeting
HEC Paris Entrepreneurship Workshop
Tilburg University
Erasmus University Rotterdam
Maastricht University
Binghamton University

2022: NBER Conference on Aging and Health
Chicago Booth Behavioral Approaches to Financial Decision Making Conference
University of Sao Paulo (Economics)

2021: AFA
Behavioral Economics Annual Meeting (BEAM)
Finance, Organizations and Markets (FOM) Conference

2020: AFA*
UCL (Economics)
University of Pennsylvania (Wharton)
University of Michigan (Ross)
University of Maryland (Smith)
Yale SOM (Behavioral Finance Guest Lecture)

2019: NBER Organizational Economics Fall Meeting*
Finance, Organizations and Markets (FOM) Conference

UC Berkeley–Stanford Joint Finance Seminar

2018: UC Berkeley–Stanford Joint Behavioral Economics Mini-Conference*

University of Bonn briq Workshop on Skills, Preferences, and Educational Inequality*

2017: UC Berkeley–Stanford Joint Finance Seminar

Grants and Awards

Wharton AI & Analytics Initiative Research Grant, 2026
Charles Brandes Prize, 2025
Jack Treynor Prize, 2025
Wharton AI & Analytics Initiative Research Grant, 2024
Best Paper Award at Mid-Atlantic Research Conference in Finance (MARC) for "What Drives Very Long-Run Cash Flow Expectations?", 2024
Jacobs Levy Equity Management Center for Quantitative Financial Research Grant, 2024
Wharton Finance Department Research Grant, 2023
Jacobs Levy Equity Management Center for Quantitative Financial Research Grant, 2023
Wharton Teaching Excellence Award, 2023
Jacobs Levy Equity Management Center for Quantitative Financial Research Grant, 2022
Wharton Teaching Excellence Award, 2022
Analytics at Wharton Research Grant, 2021
Minder Cheng Research Fellowship, 2017–2018
Haas School of Business Departmental Fellowship, 2015–2020
Südwestmetall Junior Scholars Award, 2015
Germany Scholarship of the Federal Government (Deutschlandstipendium), 2012–2014
Julius-Paul-Stiegler Scholarship, 2011–2012
Erasmus Scholarship, 2011–2012
University of Mannheim Scholarship, 2010–2011

Teaching

Wharton

Behavioral Finance, Undergraduate, Instructor, 2021–
  Wharton Teaching Excellence Award, 2021-22, 2022-23
Behavioral Finance, MBA, Instructor, 2024–
Empirical Methods in Corporate Finance, PhD, Co-Instructor, 2023–

UC Berkeley

Corporate Finance, Evening MBA, Teaching Assistant, 2019
Empirical Corporate Finance, PhD, Teaching Assistant, 2019

University of Mannheim

Corporate Finance, Master's, Teaching Assistant, 2014–2015

Professional Activities

Session Chair

AFA, 2025 (“Behavioral Corporate Finance”)
NFA, 2023 (“Product Market Interactions”)

Referee

American Economics Journal: Economic Policy, *American Economic Review*, *Journal of Banking and Finance*, *Journal of Corporate Finance*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*, *Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Macroeconomics*, *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, *Labour Economics*, *Management Science*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Corporate Finance Studies*, *Review of Finance*, *Review of Financial Studies*

Reviewer

National Science Foundation, Icelandic Research Fund

Program Chair

Mid-Atlantic Research Conference in Finance, Corporate Finance Track, 2025

Program Committee

WFA, 2024, 2025, 2026
MFA, 2024, 2026
SFS Cavalcade North America, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
EFA, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Human x AI Finance Conference, 2026

Organizer

Wharton Finance Department Social Events Coordinator, 2021–
Wharton Finance Department Brownbag Seminar, 2021–2022
Wharton Finance Department External Seminar (Micro, Co-Organizer), 2020–2021
UC Berkeley–Stanford Joint Seminar Ph.D. Session, 2017, 2018
UC Berkeley Financial Economics Ph.D. Seminar, 2018, 2019

Committees

Wharton Finance Department Micro Junior Recruiting Committee, 2022–2023

Speaking Engagements

Retail Investors Affinity Group, Wharton Club of New York, 2021

Selected Research Assistantships

Research Assistant to Professor Ulrike Malmendier, 2016–2018
Assisted with chapter on *Behavioral Corporate Finance*, published in the *Handbook of Behavioral Economics*, Vol. 1, Elsevier, 2018

Selected Commentaries and Media Coverage

Should facial analysis help determine whom companies hire?, The Economist, 11/2025
Faces, Personality, and Success, Financial Times, 11/2025
Can Your Face Predict Your Salary? Using AI Personality Assessments in Hiring, Knowledge at Wharton, 11/2025
Hidden Costs of CEO Stress, Interview with O'Donnell Center for Behavioral Economics, 11/2025
Going deeper, Fortune Magazine's CFO Daily Newsletter, 07/2025
What Shapes Analysts' Long-term Forecasts?, Knowledge at Wharton, 07/2025
What Shapes Analysts' Long-Term Forecasts?, Finance at Wharton Discoveries, 03/2025
AI Personality Extraction from Faces: Labor Market Implications, Marginal Revolution, 02/2025
AI Photo Analysis Illuminates How Personality Traits Predict Career Trajectories, Yale Insights, 01/2025
How to Survive Being a 24/7 Boss, The Wall Street Journal, 02/2024
Managerial stress accelerates aging and increases mortality among CEOs, IZA Commentary, 10/2023
How Sunk Costs Affect Firms' Investment Decisions, Knowledge at Wharton, 01/2023
One Secret to a Longer Life: Don't Become CEO in an Embattled Industry, The Wall Street Journal, 09/2021
Managerial Stress Can Literally Take Years Off Your Life, Forbes, 09/2021
Executive stress tests, The New York Times DealBook, 03/2021
Stressed-out CEOs visibly age faster and die earlier, Business Insider, 03/2021
Being a CEO is a deadly affair, MarketWatch, 03/2021
How Biases Influence CEOs Throughout Their Careers, Knowledge at Wharton, 02/2021
Interview on Life Cycle of a CEO Career, Wharton on SiriusXM, 02/2021
Behavioral Corporate Finance: The Life Cycle of a CEO Career, Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance, 12/2020
Stress Marks, Berkeley Haas Magazine, 12/2020
Interview on CEO Stress, Aging, and Death, Wharton on SiriusXM, 10/2020
Job stress takes a heavy toll on CEO lifespan, Newswise, 10/2020
Can the Stress of Being the Boss Make You Age Faster?, Quartz, 09/2020
Recessions reduce managers' life expectancy, FAZ, 08/2020
Shareholder activism is basically murder, Bloomberg (Money Stuff), 08/2020
CEO stress, aging, and death, Marginal Revolution, 08/2020

Advising

Ph.D.

Rick Kaser, Wharton Finance Ph.D. Candidate, Committee Member (in progress)
Zhongtian Chen, Wharton Finance Ph.D. Candidate, Committee Member
Placement: University of Wisconsin-Madison, 2025

Other

Leah Li, Wharton Finance Predoctoral Research Assistant (in progress)
Shuman Zhang, Wharton Finance Predoctoral Research Assistant
Placement: Maryland Finance Ph.D. program, 2025
Tim (Qian) Zhang, Wharton Finance Predoctoral Research Assistant
Placement: Kellogg Finance Ph.D. program, 2023
Jay Mammen, Wharton Undergraduate Research Scholar Thesis Program, 2025–2026
Michael Sun, Wharton Undergraduate Research Scholar Thesis Program, 2023–2024
Federico Segura, MBA Independent Study Project in Finance
Puneet Thiara, MBA Independent Study Project in Finance

Non-Academic Work Experience

Deutsche Lufthansa AG, Study and Intensive Practice Mentorship and Internship Program in Finance, 2009–2012

Skills

Computer: Stata, Python, R, LaTeX
Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)